

CHOKED CHANNELS

Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD) reading is a parameter to judge the general quality of water

A BOD reading of 2mg/l or less means the water is potable without treatment; 2-3 mg/l means it is drinkable only after treatment; over 3mg/l, it is unusable even for fish and wildlife

RIVER	BOD Ratings*
Ganga	21 at Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh
Godavari	20 at Tapovan
Gomati	14 at Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
Khan	50 at Indore, Madhya Pradesh
Krishna	17.6 at Mahuli, Maharashtra
Musi	34 at Rangareddy, Andhra Pradesh
Narmada	11.4 at Hoshangabad, MP
Sabarmati	48 at Vautha, Gujarat
Satluj	48 at Ludhiana, Punjab
Tapi	21 at Ajnand, Maharashtra
Wainganga	10.5 at Ashti, Maharashtra
Yamuna	70 at Okhla, Delhi
Subarnarekha	10.5 at Tatisilwai, Jharkhand

The readings are from the Central Pollution Control Board

SANJAY SONKAR



AS GONE UP THREE-FOLD AND THAT IN THE YAMUNA BY SEVEN TIMES.

The plan was an expansion of the 1985 Ganga Action Plan, covering 18 grossly polluted river stretches in 10 states at a projected cost of Rs 772 crore. It has now spread to 167 towns in 20 states and includes 38 rivers, including its latest entry, the Panchganga in August 2009

Today, the NRCP is not a focussed, successful environmental plan but a bureaucratic abacus whose only job is to add up the moving columns. Officers of NRCP have so far spent over Rs 94.97

lakh on foreign trips to the USA, the UK, Israel, the Netherlands, Japan, Austria and Australia to study the pollution control mechanism of these countries. Its programme has cost an enormous Rs 3,892 crore, but the consequences have been a series of failures. Before August 2009, the NRCP had to focus on around 2,500 km of polluted stretches from the 22,127 km of 37 rivers. Even as the expenditure for every kilometre of polluted river has risen over

THE KHAN

The Indore stretch of this 56-km long river is the most polluted among the rivers of Madhya Pradesh. Since 1995, Rs 39.55 crore have been spent on a clean-up but it still remains filthy